



Plants for textured foliage

Plants with textured foliage make ideal specimens, creating impact when used on their own as focal points or as a contrast to their neighbors.

One of the main tools of a garden designer's trade, textured foliage offers year-round interest and looks most effective when teamed with contrasting smooth or shiny leaves. Conifers, such as pines and spruces, produce stems of evergreen, brushlike leaves that combine well with a boxwood topiary or an undershirt of heather for a year-round textural display. As part of a seasonal scheme at the front of a sunny bed, try the downy leaves of lamb's ears with the blue, spiky foliage of a Mediterranean sea holly. In a shady spot bring together a collection of ferns, hostas, and frilly, burgundy-leaved coral bells for a feast of textures.



TREE SMALL

Acer palmatum 'Sango-kaku'

CORAL-BARK MAPLE This deciduous tree's divided foliage, borne on coral-red stems, offers three seasons of interest, unfurling pinkish yellow in spring, turning green in summer, and then butter-yellow in fall.

↑25ft (8m) ↔12ft (4m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6-8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Begonia 'Escargot'

BEGONIA This tender evergreen perennial offers large attractive spiral-shaped, purple-tinted green leaves with silver swirly markings and small pink flowers in fall. Grow it as a house plant in winter, and outdoors in a pot in summer.

↑10in (25cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z10-11



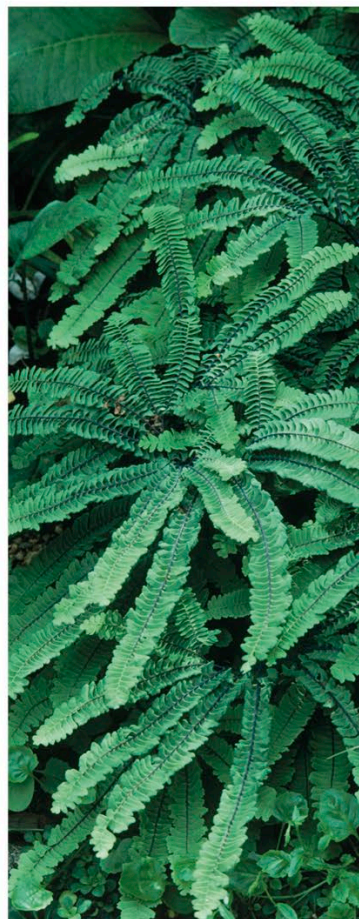
TREE LARGE

Betula ermanii

ERMAN'S BIRCH This decorative deciduous tree, prized for its peeling cream bark on the trunk and papery brown bark on the branches, also features textured, distinctly veined, toothed oval foliage, which turns yellow in fall. Catkins appear in spring.

↑70ft (20m) ↔40ft (12m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Adiantum aleuticum

WESTERN MAIDENHAIR FERN A deciduous or semievergreen fern with small pale green branching fronds, clothed with oblong leaflets that create an exciting textural effect. New fronds may be tinged pink. Try at the front of a bed with dwarf daffodils.

↑18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8 (N)



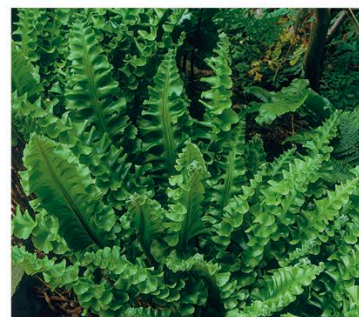
TREE SMALL

Acacia baileyana

COOTAMUNDRA WATTLE An evergreen tree with finely cut, decorative silvery gray leaves, which contrast well with plants bearing smooth green foliage and, from late winter to spring, fingerlike clusters of fluffy yellow flowers. Grow in neutral to acidic soil.

↑20ft (6m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z9-11



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Asplenium scolopendrium

HART'S TONGUE FERN This rosette-forming evergreen fern has leathery, bright green tongue-shaped fronds. The spores beneath the fronds create a striped effect on upper surfaces. Forms such as Crispum Group (above) have crinkled-edged leaves.

↑28in (70cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Brunnera macrophylla

SIBERIAN BUGLOSS This perennial is ideal for use as ground cover in partly-shaded gardens. Grown for its oval tapering leaves with soft hairs, often speckled or edged with silvery white (above), and sprays of small bright blue flowers appear in spring.

↑18in (45cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8